



Financial Anxiety Is Real

But You Don't Have to Face It Alone

It's no secret that money worries weigh heavily on many Americans. Way back in 2021, 71% of employees said they were anxious about their financial futures. Fast forward to today, and that number has skyrocketed to a **stunning 91%**.

Inflation—*surprise, surprise*—tops the list of anxieties across all generations. But it's far from the only concern. **Stock market volatility**, **rising credit card balances**, and uncertainty around **retirement readiness** have also pushed financial stress to new highs.

The Numbers Behind the Nervousness

Today's financial landscape is complex. Nearly half of Americans (48%) expect they'll need more than \$1 million to retire comfortably—but only 27% believe they'll actually reach that goal. This gap between expectations and confidence is driving much of the unease advisors see every day.

Despite those worries, many are taking proactive steps. The number of people contributing to their **401(k)** plans has jumped from 70% in 2022 to 91% today—an encouraging sign that investors are still focused on long-term planning. Interest in **alternative investments** has also expanded dramatically, with 87% of workers expressing curiosity about private equity, cryptocurrency, or other nontraditional strategies. Alternative investments, including private equity and cryptocurrency, may involve higher risk, limited liquidity, and may not be suitable for all investors.

Why This Matters for Investors

Financial anxiety isn't just emotional—it affects behavior. When anxiety spikes, some investors pull back from opportunities, delay savings decisions, or make reactionary moves in volatile markets.

Others may chase high-risk investments in hopes of “catching up.” That's where professional advice can make a difference. A well-structured financial plan acts like an emotional anchor, helping investors focus on long-term goals rather than short-term noise. Understanding your personal risk tolerance and reviewing your plan regularly can turn uncertainty into clarity.

Turning Anxiety Into Action

If you're feeling financially uncertain, you're not alone. The good news is that these challenges are manageable with the right strategies:

- **Revisit your plan.** Life and markets change—your plan should too.
- **Automate savings and investing.** Removing emotion from the decision-making process builds consistency.
- **Diversify intelligently.** Explore different asset classes, including alternatives, but ensure they align with your goals and risk profile.
- **Talk it through.** Financial anxiety eases when you have a trusted advisor helping you make sense of the headlines.

Anxiety may be rising, but so is awareness—and with proactive planning and informed guidance, investors can regain confidence in their financial future.

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